

PELICAN BAY POLICE DEPARTMENT
 HOMICIDE DIVISION — EIGHTH DISTRICT

715 South Broad Avenue, New Orleans, LA 70119
 (504) 658-6080

WITNESS STATEMENT — INITIAL (FIRST INTERVIEW)

Case No.: PBPD-2025-088142 | Document No.: 11

Witness: SHANNON O'BRIEN
 Race/Sex/DOB: F/W, June 14, 1999 (Age 26)
 Occupation: Bartender, The Rusty Anchor, 712 Bourbon Street
 Statement Date: October 4, 2025
 Statement Time: 5:30 AM – 6:00 AM
 Location: The Rusty Anchor — Back Office
 Interviewing Detective: Det. Renee Broussard, Badge #1887
 Miranda Advisory: Not required — witness, not suspect
 Case Number: PBPD-2025-088142

[BEGIN TRANSCRIBED STATEMENT]

I've been bartending at The Rusty Anchor for about two years. I was working the closing shift last night — I came on at 6 PM and was supposed to close up at 3 AM.

We were busy. Friday nights on Bourbon are always crazy. Around midnight, maybe a little after, I noticed a situation at the far end of the bar. There was a Black man — I didn't know him, he wasn't a regular — and he had been talking with a young woman most of the night. The woman is Derek's ex. Derek Fontenot. He comes in a lot.

Derek got upset when he saw her with this other man. He walked over and things got heated. They were arguing — Derek and the other man. I couldn't hear everything, music was loud. I went over and told them to cool it or take it outside. It seemed to settle down after that.

A little while later — maybe around 1:15 or so — the man I didn't know left through the back. I don't know why he used the back door. Maybe he knew where it was. Maybe someone told him. I don't know.

After that the night sort of moved on. I started closing prep. I didn't see anything else unusual until the police showed up. That's when I found out something had happened in the alley.

The man arguing with Marcus — that's Derek Fontenot. He's a regular. He tips okay. I've never seen him get violent but he has a temper sometimes.

[END STATEMENT]

NOTE: This statement was given voluntarily. Witness identified the incident as an altercation between the victim and DEREK FONTENOT only. No mention of additional individuals involved. Detective Broussard noted witness appeared nervous and guarded during interview. Follow-up interview scheduled.

Witness Signature: _____ Shannon O'Brien
 Detective Signature: _____ Renee Broussard #1887
 Date: October 4, 2025